

VIA Race III — Ultima Thule

Executive Summary · Netherlands → Norway · ~4,000 km · July 24 – August 13, 2026

Distance note: All distances and speeds are clipped to each rider's verified race window (start gate → Volda finish gate). Post-finish tracker movement is excluded; four riders had their raw odometer corrected as a result.

Field Overview

Starters	Finishers	DNF	DNS	Finish Rate	Race Window
62	32	22	8	52%	Jul 24 – Aug 13, 2026

Key Metrics

Metric	Value
Winning time	8d 15h — Adam Bialek
Last finisher	20d 12h — Enrico Halix & Malte Weise
Spread (1st to last)	11.89 days
Median finish time	13.81 days
Distance range (finishers)	3,384 – 4,052 km (667 km spread)
Moving speed range	15.9 – 21.9 km/h

Full Results — 32 Finishers

Rest% = proportion of elapsed time spent in detected rest stops (GPS speed < 3 km/h for ≥ 45 min).

#	Rider	Time	km	km/h	Rest%
1	Adam Bialek	8d 15h	3,491	21.5	9%
2	Bruno Wicht	8d 22h	3,395	19.8	10%
3	Jair Hoogland	9d 12h	3,435	19.6	15%
4	Juhani Saario	9d 23h	3,414	19.5	13%
5	Lucas Becker	9d 23h	3,508	21.9	21%
6	Gert Jan Schilder	10d 07h	3,747	20.0	11%
7	James Gill	11d 03h	3,477	19.4	21%
8	Viktor Kovachev	11d 10h	3,713	20.8	25%
9	Krystian Jakubek	11d 12h	3,440	18.4	19%
10	Craig Nilsson	12d 07h	3,656	17.6	13%
11	Anthony ZARRA	12d 07h	3,613	18.6	24%
12	Rafael Ospino	12d 16h	3,520	18.6	25%
13	Mathias Mücke	12d 23h	3,384	18.1	29%
14	Matthew Downie	12d 23h	3,595	21.3	30%
15	Samuel Cibulka	13d 13h	3,544	19.7	32%
16	Gernot Stenz	13d 14h	3,756	16.1	13%
17	Jan-Willem Bobbink	14d 01h	3,551	18.8	23%
18	Bjoern Stiel	14d 02h	3,544	17.4	21%
19	Dr. Philipp Lührs	14d 07h	3,508	20.0	30%

#	Rider	Time	km	km/h	Rest%
20	Johann Bollen	14d 09h	3,559	18.1	27%
21	Ralph Brune	14d 12h	3,515	19.3	30%
22	Robin Smith	14d 15h	3,541	18.1	31%
23	Brent Olson	15d 01h	3,483	17.3	26%
24	Connie Etter	15d 01h	3,460	17.0	24%
25	Anisa Aubin	15d 04h	3,565	15.9	20%
26	Peter Kuhn	15d 08h	3,580	19.2	31%
27	Laurens Wolting	15d 11h	3,541	18.1	34%
28	Philipp Burgmer	15d 14h	3,620	18.2	40%
29	Sarah Elena Prieto Peña	18d 10h	3,620	16.8	35%
30	CÉSAR OBESO DíEZ	18d 10h	3,646	16.3	39%
31	Jason Vail	19d 13h	3,581	16.1	37%
32	Enrico Halix & Malte Weise	20d 12h	4,052	19.6	37%

Route Highlights

Rider	Rank	Route	Note
Juhani Saario	#4	3,414 km	131 km shorter than field median (3,544 km). Matched #5 Lucas Becker's finish time within 2 min.
Mathias Mücke	#13	3,384 km	Shortest route among all finishers.
Enrico Halix & Malte Weise	#32	4,052 km	Longest route — 507 km above median, via strategic loops through Strynefjell and Sognefjord circuits.

Fastest Segment Spotlights — Average Moving Speed

Leg	Character	Fastest rider	Best km/h	Median km/h
Sognefjellet → Lom	~1,400 m descent off Norway's highest road	Matthew Downie	38.7	29.6
Lysebotn → Botn	Long valley exit from Lysefjord	Matthew Downie	25.3	18.3
Botn → Vøringfossen	Fjord valley to Hardanger plateau	Matthew Downie	24.6	18.7
Brocken → Fredriksten	Germany–Denmark–Norway push	Bruno Wicht	28.3	23.8
Suleskard → Lysebotn	High-alpine traverse to fjord bottom	Robin Smith	21.6	17.1

■ On Suleskard → Lysebotn, Robin Smith recorded the highest moving speed (21.6 km/h), but Bruno Wicht completed the leg gate-to-gate fastest (2.4 hrs) with fewer stops.

Matthew Downie — fastest moving speed on 4 of 11 common legs: Lysebotn → Botn (25.3 km/h), Sognefjellet → Lom (38.7 km/h), Botn → Vøringfossen (24.6 km/h), Urnes → Gaularfjellet (22.4 km/h). He finished #14 overall, demonstrating elite segment pace across the full length of the route.

Gate-to-Gate Segment Analysis — All Common Legs

Legs shared by ≥ 20 of the 32 finishers. Avg moving speed excludes time below 2 km/h. ★ = Matthew Downie fastest.

Leg	Riders	Median km/h	Fastest rider	Best km/h
Brocken → Fredriksten	32	23.8	Bruno Wicht	28.3
Suleskard → Lysebotn	32	17.1	Robin Smith	21.6
★ Lysebotn → Botn	29	18.3	Matthew Downie	25.3
Vøringfossen → Borgund	23	22.3	Jan-Willem Bobbink	26.5

Leg	Riders	Median km/h	Fastest rider	Best km/h
★ Sognefjellet → Lom	27	29.6	Matthew Downie	38.7
Svøufallet → Atlantic Rd	30	21.9	Juhani Saario	25.1
Vestkapp → Volda	28	20.6	Dr. Philipp Lührs	23.8
★ Botn → Vøringfossen	28	18.7	Matthew Downie	24.6
Fredriksten → Suleskard	29	18.7	Bruno Wicht	23.1
Start → Brocken	32	25.6	Lucas Becker	29.1
★ Urnes → Gaularfjellet	21	19.1	Matthew Downie	22.4

Yellow = fastest beat median by ≥ 8 km/h.

Sleep & Rest Analysis

Rest periods: GPS speed < 3 km/h for 45+ consecutive minutes. Top 4 finishers rested under 15% of race time; field average ~24%.

Rider	Stops	Total rest	Rest%	Longest stop
Adam Bialek	9	18.4h	9%	5.0h
Bruno Wicht	4	20.8h	10%	11.8h
Jair Hoogland	9	34.5h	15%	5.5h
Juhani Saario	9	31.2h	13%	4.5h
Lucas Becker	12	49.5h	21%	9.1h
Gert Jan Schilder	7	27.7h	11%	6.2h
James Gill	10	55.0h	21%	9.4h
Viktor Kovachev	11	67.4h	25%	8.3h
Krystian Jakubek	17	52.3h	19%	10.4h
Craig Nilsson	14	38.4h	13%	7.7h
Anthony ZARRA	12	71.0h	24%	9.7h
Rafael Ospino	21	77.5h	25%	10.8h
Mathias Mücke	19	90.2h	29%	10.5h
Matthew Downie	20	92.6h	30%	14.6h
Samuel Cibilka	20	104.5h	32%	13.6h
Gernot Stenz	11	41.1h	13%	7.5h
Jan-Willem Bobbink	12	77.0h	23%	15.8h
Bjoern Stiel	18	72.5h	21%	8.3h
Dr. Philipp Lührs	23	101.4h	30%	10.7h
Johann Bollen	20	93.1h	27%	9.0h
Ralph Brune	16	104.3h	30%	11.2h
Robin Smith	13	108.2h	31%	36.8h
Brent Olson	22	93.9h	26%	9.9h
Connie Etter	23	85.9h	24%	7.8h
Anisa Aubin	20	73.0h	20%	10.7h
Peter Kuhn	19	115.8h	31%	11.4h
Laurens Wolting	22	124.5h	34%	10.6h
Philipp Burgmer	17	151.3h	40%	34.1h

Rider	Stops	Total rest	Rest%	Longest stop
Sarah Elena Prieto Peña	37	156.1h	35%	13.8h
CÉSAR OBESO DÍEZ	40	173.4h	39%	13.9h
Jason Vail	48	173.4h	37%	13.5h
Enrico Halix & Malte Weise	32	180.3h	37%	38.0h

DNF Riders — Gates Reached

Rider	Gates hit	Distance
Bob Watts	16/19	3,034 km
George Magner	16/19	2,980 km
Gill Crane	15/19	3,340 km
David Hausberg	13/19	3,006 km
Alice Renault	12/19	2,755 km
Ole Hilbert	8/19	2,724 km
Jens Horstmann	8/19	2,713 km
Marc Büchel	8/19	—
Richard Hatton	8/19	—
Harry Johnson	7/19	—
Mark Van Ham	7/19	—
Pal Kerekcs	5/19	—
Thijs de Blok	4/19	—
Mateusz Tondel	4/19	—
alexander groehl	3/19	—
Jeremy Martin	3/19	—
Simon Mowles	3/19	—
Sam Muscat	3/19	—
Johannes Zapotoczky	2/19	—
Gregor Towers	2/19	—
Alexandre Duros	2/19	—
Antony Lewis	0/19	—

Category Breakdown

Category	Starters	Finishers	Finish rate
F	3	1	33%
M	52	26	50%
Pair	7	5	71%

Route Variation by Segment

Distance spread between finishers gate-to-gate. Tight through Germany/Scandinavia, then explodes in the Norwegian fjords. Rows with ≥ 500 km spread are highlighted.

Segment	N	Min km	Median	Max km	Spread	Shortest	Longest
Start → Brocken	32	393	407	488	95	Saario	Weise
Brocken → Fredriksten	32	937	967	1022	85	Wicht	Downie
Fredriksten → Botn	32	281	546	605	324	Saario	Schilder
Botn → Suleskard	3	121	121	123	2	Weise	Aubin
Suleskard → Lysebotn	32	33	36	39	6	Jakubek	Stenz
Lysebotn → Vøringfossen	31	251	318	384	133	Hoogland	Weise
Vøringfossen → Sognefjellet	31	303	513	652	349	Aubin	Stenz
Sognefjellet → Gaularfjellet	7	122	126	949	827	Kovachev	DíEZ
Gaularfjellet → Strynefjell	30	185	482	1006	821	ZARRA	Wolting
Borgund → Urnes	23	130	136	983	853	Schilder	DíEZ
Urnes → Lom	29	101	286	740	639	Bollen	Weise
Lom → Svøufallet	32	180	194	627	446	Ospino	Bobbink
Svøufallet → Atlantic Rd	30	117	158	172	55	Mücke	Wolting
Atlantic Rd → Trollstigen	18	129	146	150	21	Saario	Smith
Trollstigen → Dalsnibba	14	68	69	76	8	Smith	Downie
Dalsnibba → Vestkapp	31	192	621	994	802	Weise	DíEZ
Vestkapp → Volda	29	97	99	926	829	Bobbink	Nilsson

Fastest Segment Leaders

Best elapsed time gate-to-gate among finishers.

Segment	Fastest rider	Time
Start → Brocken	Lucas Becker	15.0h
Brocken → Fredriksten	Adam Bialek	44.1h
Fredriksten → Botn	Juhani Saario	20.9h
Botn → Suleskard	Juhani Saario	7.2h
Suleskard → Lysebotn	Matthew Downie	2.4h
Lysebotn → Vøringfossen	Adam Bialek	22.3h
Vøringfossen → Sognefjellet	Viktor Kovachev	24.4h
Sognefjellet → Gaularfjellet	Enrico Halix & Malte Weise	9.7h
Gaularfjellet → Strynefjell	Viktor Kovachev	12.1h
Borgund → Urnes	Jair Hoogland	8.5h
Urnes → Lom	Johann Bollen	7.1h
Lom → Svøufallet	Bruno Wicht	9.2h
Svøufallet → Atlantic Rd	Lucas Becker	6.8h
Atlantic Rd → Trollstigen	Jair Hoogland	8.0h
Trollstigen → Dalsnibba	James Gill	5.5h
Dalsnibba → Vestkapp	Matthew Downie	10.4h
Vestkapp → Volda	Dr. Philipp Lührs	5.2h

Data: VIA Race III GPS export (via-race-26), exported 2026-09-02. Gate detection radius 1,000 m haversine. Status derived from gate compliance. Three riders are confirmed as official finishers by race organisers via override, independent of gate detection.